In the meantime, a letter by some thirty Harvard student organizations that declared Israel “entirely responsible,” when the news came out about the Hamas atrocities, created a chain of backlashes. Some are comparing the reactions of Jewish donors canceling their financial support for Harvard, as well as the publication of personal identifying details of the students involved, to Senator Joe McCarthy’s anticommunist campaign in the 1950s; others point to the implicit or explicit antisemitism in the position of pro-Hamas supporters and allude to the fearfulness of some heads of major universities to take a stand against pro-Hamas, mainly leftist organizations.

I always considered myself as being on the center-left in politics, mainly due to my support for the two-state solution. In Israel, I voted for a small party, Meretz, which advocated this. Nowadays, however, one has to be careful: part of the left has become so radicalized that one has to tread very carefully when defining one’s political leanings. The process started in the 1960s, but in many cases traditional social democracy has steadily been emptied of its content, so when you say that you are on the left today, that places you somewhere else.

Thursday, October 19

As of this morning, which is already midafternoon in Israel and the twelfth day after the Hamas attack, there is nothing to report in terms of military operations. This may indicate a cleverly camouflaged next step or basic indecision. This situation cannot go on for long because it has a negative impact on the morale of the hundreds of thousands of reservists who have been called up for an operation in Gaza. And if the bombings of northern Gaza continue without any end in sight, international public opinion will undoubtedly become ever more critical of Israel. If Israel does nothing, Hamas and its allies will claim victory. And what happens to the hostages